Leave Policy

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1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Brightwave Analytics, how leave is earned, and how to apply for it. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees. Interns and contractors are covered by the terms in their individual contracts.

The leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. All leave is recorded in the HR portal, which is the single source of truth for leave balances.

2. Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 18 days of annual leave per leave year. Annual leave accrues at 1.5 days for each completed month of service. Part-time employees receive annual leave in proportion to their contracted hours.

Employees on probation may use annual leave as it accrues, but may not take more than 5 days of annual leave in a single stretch during probation.

3. Applying for annual leave

Annual leave of more than 3 consecutive working days must be requested in the HR portal at least 7 days before the first day of leave. Shorter annual leave should be requested at least 1 working day in advance. Your reporting manager approves or declines the request within 3 working days.

4. Carry forward and encashment

Up to 10 days of unused annual leave can be carried forward into the next leave year. Any unused annual leave above 10 days lapses on 31 March and cannot be recovered.

Annual leave cannot be encashed while you are employed. When you leave the company, unused annual leave of up to 30 days is paid out at your basic salary rate as part of the full and final settlement.

5. Sick leave

Employees receive 12 days of sick leave per leave year. Sick leave is credited in full on 1 April and does not carry forward.

A medical certificate from a registered doctor is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days. Inform your manager of sick leave before 10:00 on the first day of absence, or as soon as reasonably possible.

6. Casual leave

Employees receive 6 days of casual leave per leave year for personal matters. Casual leave cannot be taken for more than 3 consecutive days and cannot be combined with annual leave. Unused casual leave lapses at the end of the leave year.

7. Parental leave

Maternity leave is 26 weeks of paid leave for an employee's first two children, and 12 weeks for a third or later child, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Up to 8 weeks of maternity leave can be taken before the expected delivery date.

Paternity leave is 10 working days of paid leave. It must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption, and can be split into two blocks.

Adoption leave for a child under 3 months old is 12 weeks of paid leave from the date of adoption.

8. Bereavement leave

Employees receive 5 working days of paid bereavement leave on the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family means a spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law.

9. Public holidays

The company observes 12 public holidays each year: 10 fixed holidays and 2 optional holidays chosen by each employee from the published list. The holiday calendar is published in the HR portal every March.

10. Leave without pay

Leave without pay of up to 30 days may be granted once all other paid leave is used. It requires approval from both your reporting manager and the HR Business Partner.